

RESPONSE B

🌟 Assistant

For a Small and Medium Enterprise (SME) customer in the Singapore region (Southeast Asia), Azure typically positions itself competitively against GCP by offering specific hybrid benefits and reservation discounts.

Below is a breakdown of the current Azure competitor pricing for the requested services in the Singapore region.

1. VM Compute (Virtual Machines)

For SMEs, General Purpose (D-Series) or Burstable (B-Series) instances are the standard. Prices vary based on the OS (Linux vs. Windows).

VM Family	Example Size	vCPU / RAM	Monthly (Estimated Pay-As-You-Go)	Notes
Burstable (B-Series)	B2s	2 vCPU / 4 GB	~\$30 - \$40	Best for low-CPU baseline with spikes.
General Purpose	D2as v5	2 vCPU / 8 GB	~\$70 - \$90	Standard SME production workload.
Compute Optimized	F2s v2	2 vCPU / 4 GB	~\$60 - \$80	Good for batch processing or web servers.

- **Savings Opportunity:** SMEs can save up to 65% using [Azure Savings Plans](#) or [Reserved Instances](#) (1-3 year commitments).

2. Managed SQL Instances (Azure SQL Database)

Azure offers two primary models: **vCore** (modern, flexible) and **DTU** (simpler, bundled).

vCore Model (Recommended for SME Flexibility)

Tier	vCPUs	RAM	Monthly (Estimated)	Notes
General Purpose	2 vCores	10.2 GB	~\$370	Standard production performance.
Serverless	0.5 - 80 vCores	Auto-scale	Pay-per-second	Best for intermittent workloads; ~\$0.52/vCore-hour.

DTU Model (Simpler Budgeting)

Tier	Performance (DTUs)	Included Storage	Monthly (Estimated)
Basic	5	2 GB	~\$5.00
Standard (S0)	10	250 GB	~\$15.00
Standard (S3)	100	250 GB	~\$150.00

- **Azure Hybrid Benefit:** If the customer already has SQL Server licenses, they can save up to 55% on these prices.

3. Outbound Network Traffic (Data Egress)

Azure charges for data leaving their data centers to the internet. **Inbound data is always free.**

Usage Tier (per month)	Price per GB (Singapore)
First 5 GB	Free
5 GB to 10 TB	~\$0.087 to \$0.12
10 TB to 50 TB	~\$0.083 to \$0.09

- **Regional Note:** Singapore is categorized under **Zone 2** or **Zone 3** in some Azure billing structures, which often carries a slightly higher rate than US or Europe regions (typically starting around **\$0.12/GB** for the first tier in Southeast Asia).

Strategic Competitive Points for GCP Sales

- **Committed Use Discounts (CUDs):** Highlight how GCP's "Flexible CUDs" compare to Azure's more rigid Reservation models.
- **Sustained Use Discounts:** Unlike Azure, GCP automatically applies discounts for long-running VMs without requiring upfront commitments.
- **Free Tier:** GCP often has a more generous **Always Free Tier** for SMEs testing small workloads.

Would you like me to create a direct price-comparison table between specific GCP machine types (like N2 or E2) and their Azure equivalents in Singapore?